AI resumes are a headache

LinkedIn's **Nithya Rajagopalan** explains how AI is the solution

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It's crazy and unbelievable to think about it, but the thing losing most value in the hiring process is an applicant's CV. Just think about it, everyone and their grandma now uses ChatGPT, Gemini and Claude to spruce up their resumes that would put everyone from Sundar Pichai to Elon Musk to shame.

And LinkedIn knows about this problem only too well. Just like LinkedIn is developing AI to help recruiters, it's well aware that job applicants are using AI to oversell and stand out in the jobs marketplace. Resumes are becoming more AI-tweaked, some even AI-written, and "it's a moving problem," says Nithya Rajagopalan, Director of Engineering of LinkedIn Talent Solutions India. During my recent interview with her, she flagged this rising trend of AI-enhanced CV as a major problem Liha, LinkedIn's Hiring Assistant is tackling at scale – not just in India but globally.

The solution implemented by LinkedIn is not about more clever parsing. It's about getting more evidence. The platform went from verifying your place of employment to actually validating your ten most important skills and finding evidence for their validity through confirmation of their actual use and certification of them. This may not be glamorous work, but it may very well be the only solution to an AI arms race.



Nithya Rajagopalan
Head of LTS Engineering, LinkedIn India

It has been six months since I last spoke with Nithya Rajagopalan, the Director of Engineering of LinkedIn Talent Solutions India. The product was still in the experimental stage back then, full of promise but not completely trusted by recruiters who were still testing the limits of this promising new idea. This experimental phase is no longer there. Liha has moved past this stage and has become infrastructure for LinkedIn's recruiters.

The plumbing nobody sees, except it's built in India

Here's the bit that should make Indian techies puff their chests out a little. When I asked Rajagopalan how much of Liha's actual model, architecture and training is India's work versus something shipped over from the US, she wasn't shy about it. "All the hard parts of the data, the platform... is built in here in India," she told me, throwing in that Liha's recent language expansions, the ones with global impact, were also engineered out of India.

Basically, the unglamorous, deeply unsexy infrastructure work, the stuff that has to survive contact with messy, real-world enterprise data, is a Bangalore problem through and through.

And enterprise hiring is about as messy as it gets. Every ATS, be it Workday, Greenhouse, or SuccessFactors, speaks a completely different dialect of data. Rajagopalan's team essentially had to build a universal translator, a layer that keeps Liha "agnostic" to whichever system it's plugged into, so nobody has to rebuild the wheel every time a new enterprise client signs on.

When your resume and your LinkedIn profile don't agree

Naturally, I had to ask the obvious troublemaker question: what happens when a candidate's ATS record says one thing and their LinkedIn profile says another? Does the algorithm just crown a winner and move on?

Turns out, no. Rajagopalan calls it a reconciliation process, and there's no dramatic verdict at the end of it. The two datasets get merged into what she calls an "enhanced profile," stitched together with verification data, so Liha works off the fullest picture available instead of picking a side. "I wouldn't say that this would win or that would win," she said. A little less dramatic than I was hoping for, but far more sensible.

Engineers don't just code

Rajagopalan was refreshingly blunt about what all this means for her own team too. Foundations haven't changed, she insists, but the days of an engineer clocking in, writing code and clocking out are gone.

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